INCH-POUND
A-A-55303
October 23, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WASHCLOTH, TERRY, COTTON AND COTTON/POLYESTER BLEND

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for DDD-W-80 for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This document covers the requirements for three types of cotton and cotton/polyester blend washcloths intended for use by Federal agencies and the Department of Defense.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The washcloths shall be in the following types:

Type I	- 16 ounces per dozen
Type II	- 11 ounces per dozen
Type III	- 16 ounces per dozen

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS. The finished dimensions of the washcloths shall be 12 inches by 12 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch. The finished washcloths shall conform to the physical requirements specified in Table I when tested. The type I and III washcloths shall consist of ground warp, pile warp, and filling yarns woven as a single-loop terry weave exclusive of a border. As alternates, the type I and III washcloths shall have a plain-woven border, 1/4 to 1/2 inch wide, either on both sides and both ends or on both ends only. The border shall be located not more than 1 inch from the ends and sides or from the ends only, whichever is applicable. The type II washcloth shall consist of ground warp, pile warp, and filling yarns woven as a single-loop terry weave. The border shall be on both sides and both ends or on both ends only. The border measurement, from the edge towards the body, shall be in this order: 3/8 to 5/8 inch plain weave, 1/8 to 3/8 inch terry, 1/16 to 3/16 inch plain weave, 1/8 to 3/8 inch terry, 1/16 to 3/16 inch plain weave, terry body. The thread for stitching shall be cotton, ticket number 30, 3-ply of A-A-52094. All four edges shall be overedge-stitched with 10 to 14 stitches per inch of stitch type 504 or 505 and stitching type EFd-1 as specified in FED-STD-751. All ends of stitching, thread breaks, and skipped and runoff stitches shall be overstitched 3/4 to 1 inch. The finished washcloth shall be free of loose or untrimmed threads. The washcloths shall be desized and bleached white. The starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material of the finished cloth shall not exceed 5.0 percent when tested in accordance with ASTM D629 (sec. 9).

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FNS, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19145-5099.

AMSC N/A **FSC 7210**

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TABLE I. Physical requirements

Characteristic	Test method	Requirement		
		Type I	Type II	Type III
Weight per dozen (ounces), min.	3.1	16	11	16
Yarns per inch (min.) Warp Filling	3.2	3.2.1	3.2.2	3.2.3
Breaking strength pounds, minimum Warp Filling	ASTM D5034	 40 35	 25 25	 57 45
Weave	3.3	single-loop terry weave		
Dimensional change in laundering	3.4	3.4	3.4	3.4
Ply Warp Ground Pile (100% cotton) Filling ply	Visual	 2 or 1 2 or 1 1	 2 or 1 2 or 1 1	 1 1 1

3.1 Weight. Testing shall be in accordance with ASTM D3776 opt. C except that samples shall be conditioned as directed in ASTM D1776 "Practice for Conditioning Textiles for Testing" prior to testing.

3.2 Yarns per inch. Testing shall be in accordance with ASTM D3775 except that eight warp and eight filling samples shall be tested.

3.2.1 Type I. There shall be a minimum of 68 warp and 35 filling yarns per inch. Either of these values may fall below this minimum by not more than three yarns, provided the combined warp and filling yarn total does not fall below 100 yarns per inch. The ground warp and filling yarns shall be either 100 percent cotton or polyester/cotton which may contain up to 70% polyester with the remaining percentage cotton.

3.2.2 Type II. There shall be a minimum of 59 warp and 29 filling yarns per inch. The ground warp and filling yarns shall be either 100 percent cotton or polyester/cotton which may contain up to 70% polyester with the remaining percentage cotton.

3.2.3 Type III. There shall be a minimum of 70 warp and 36 filling yarns per inch. The ground warp and filling yarns shall be 100% cotton or polyester/cotton which shall contain up to 14% polyester with the remaining percentage cotton.

3.3 Weave. A visual determination shall be made. One determination shall be made on each sample unit and the results reported as "pass" or "fail."

3.4 Dimensional change in laundering. After laundering, the finished dimensions of the washcloths shall be 12 inches by 12 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch. Testing shall be in accordance with AATCC 96 Opt Vc. Use drying procedure (D), or samples may be dried using a thermostatically controlled circulating oven at 221^{o} - 230^{o}F until dried. The sample shall be allowed to cool for five minutes, sprinkled with water to permit damp pressing, and allowed to stand in this condition for five minutes. The dampened specimens shall be pressed with a flatbed press as described in AATCC 96, section 5.2, or a hand iron as described in AATCC 96, section 5.10, at a temperature of 275^{o} to 300^{o}F. Section 7.4 of AATCC 96 shall not apply.

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3.5 Labels. A commercial-type label that includes laundering information is acceptable. In addition, there shall be a unit marking label containing the contractor's name, contract number, size and National Stock Number (NSN).

3.5.1 Fiber identification. In lieu of labeling each individual washcloth, the unit marking label shall include the fiber content of the washcloths in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.6 Label/tag. Each unit package shall be individually bar-coded with a paper tag. The paper tag shall be standard bleached sulfate having a basis weight of 100 pounds. The paper used for the tags shall have a smooth finish to accept thermal transfer and direct printing. The tags shall be clearly legible and readable by a scanner. The bar coding element shall be a 13 digit national stock number (NSN). The bar code type shall be a medium to high code density and shall be located so that it is completely visible on the unit package and so that it causes no damage to the item.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptance criteria. The item offered, or a generic equivalent, must have been sold to the commercial market or to the Government for at least two years.

5.3 Warranty. The item offered shall include the standard warranty given to the commercial market beginning with the date of delivery of the individual items.

5.4 Visual examination. Each washcloth shall be examined for the defects listed below.

5.4.1 Defects. Any hole, cut, or tear; color not as specified; any part shaded; any spot or stain; any material defects, distorted parts or poor workmanship; label missing, incorrect, or illegible; measurement of item not as specified; bar code omitted or not readable by scanner; human-readable interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible; bar code not visible on folded, packaged item; bar code causes damage to the item; any items not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order.

5.5 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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7. NOTES

7.1 Source of Department of Defense documents. Copies of military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

7.2 Source of non-Government documents

ASTM Test Methods

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Society For Testing and Materials, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.)

AATCC Test Method

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC), P.O. Box 12215, Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians
Army - GL
Air Force - 99

Review Activities
Army - MD
Air Force - 45, 82

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
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DLA - CT

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